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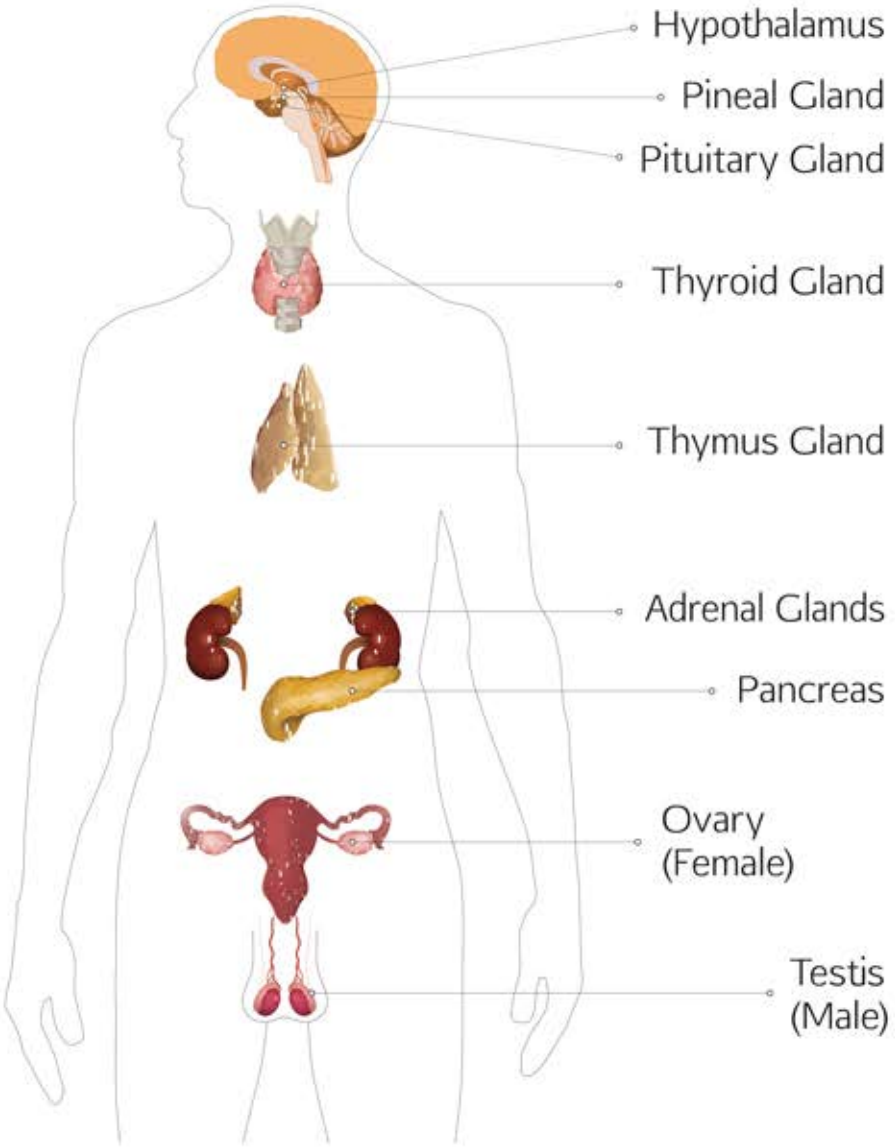


Figure :11. 1 Location of various endocrine glands

Hormones are chemical messengers because they act as organic catalysts and coenzymes to perform specific functions in the target organs. The target organs contain receptor molecules either on the surface or within the cell. Although different hormones come in contact with cells, only the cells that contain receptor molecules specific for the hormone are physiologically activated. A single hormone may have multiple effects on a single target tissue or on different target tissues.

Many hormones exhibit long term changes like growth, puberty and pregnancy. Hormones often influence many organs and organ systems at the same time. Serious deficiency or excess secretion of hormones leads to disorders. Hormones coordinate different physical, physiological, mental activities and

Homeostasis: Maintenance of constant internal environment of the body by the different coordinating system.